

Geek culture : Steampunk

Steampunk is a somewhat nostalgic science fiction genre, that looks backwards towards time and draws up an alternate timeline of events – an advanced and progressed world without electricity. Think an

advanced world with transportation and gadgets powered by steam and gears – like the worlds of Jules Verne or H.G. Wells. Recently, steampunk has grown from a marginal science fiction genre to an art and style movement. A number of steampunk modifications of modern gadgets exist on the market.

Movies

The League of Extraordinary Gentlemen

Set just before 1900, this film has a 6 wheeled car, a submarine, metallic armours with flamethrowers, and machine guns as edge of weapons technology.



Dark City

The film has one of the largest steampunk cities shown on cinema. Sequences of gigantic cityscape changing machines are a pleasure to watch.



Brazil

Undoubtedly the most critically acclaimed steampunk films, based on George Orwell's 1984. A computer glitch brands an innocent man as a terrorist.



Books

20,000 leagues under the sea

A classic Jules Verne novel featuring captain Nemo and the Nautilus. It's refreshing to read about submarines, diving suits and oxygen pumps in an era when these were not yet around, and were science fiction.



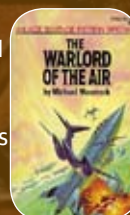
The Difference Engine

One of the defining works of the genre, featuring clockwork computers as against microchip ones. There are even renegade "clackers" who use punch cards as the tools of their trade.



Warlord of the Air

Equal parts Sci-Fi, and equal parts fantasy, Michael Moorcock's works follow an alternate timeline where the British Empire still exists and the World Wars never happened. Look out for the Airship Armadas in this one.



Gadgets

USB Drive

This just showed up in a Russian modding forum, a handcrafted, user made one of a kind piece.

This is however, one of the many modded peripherals based on steampunk aesthetics. This piece is called Zdesya.



LCD Monitor

<http://steampunkworkshop.com> has detailed shots and instructions for a number of Steam Punk modifications, including this LCD Monitor. This was made to go with the maker's keyboard.



Gakutensoku

Look closely at the lenses, there are iris shutters for each eye that can be independently controlled by sliders to let the right amount of light in – and they look cool. Instructions and more images at <http://bit.ly/PWaYz>.



Digit Diary

The month of June was pretty crazy around the office with the Digit Carnival events going on in and out of the office. Along with that, Kumar and Siddharth took part in an ARG called *Supari* that took place over three weeks. Both of them were roaming in the office with some eye-raising objects (meant to be immunity) that included some Hindi magazines and even a copy of the Mumbai city guide. They both gloated about their kills and also about their deaths in this game as both died by the hands of two different women on separate occasions. At the

end of it all, Kumar did not win anything, but since Siddharth escaped near death a couple of times he won the Slipper Supari award and received the prize of absolutely nothing.

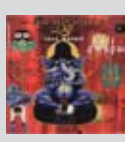
Rossi made all kinds of excuses to stay idle at home, so Robert finally brought his guitar and amp to office. As of now, Rossi has been asked to stay away from it. But we did manage to catch him trying his hand at it when no one else was watching. Vijay keeps getting gifts, Ahmed gave him his 22-inch Viewsonic last month. This month, Robert gave him his printer and his 2.1 speaker set.

How we unwind



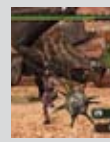
Movies

Heavy Metal: Animation that goes into the past and future, with songs by Nazareth, Black Sabbath and Blue Oyster Cult.



Music

Tabla Beat Science: A pleasant detour for the team, this month's issue closing had some fusion of Indian classical and electronica.



Game

Monster Hunter – Freedom: We've been on epic quests killing prehistoric abominations in this innovative PSP RPG.